Peer Review for Team H

Mapping & Analyzing Participation in Tutor/Mentor Leadership and Networking Conferences
B657/E583 Information Visualization | Indiana University | Spring 2026

1) Quality of Data Selection, Cleaning, Preparation, and Documentation

I think the data work here is genuinely one of the project’s strengths. The SNA normalization effort is well documented, mapping 73 raw category variants down to 11 canonical sectors in a dedicated Python module (sna_normalize.py) is exactly the kind of reproducible, code-driven approach that makes a project like this maintainable in future. I also appreciated that you ran a formal data quality audit and specifically called out the 272 blank organization records (4.2%) and the 323 whitespace issues rather than silently dropping them. That level of transparency is great.

That said, there are some numerical inconsistencies across your documents that need to be reconciled before the final submission. Your intermediate report says the dataset contains 6,410 records, but your client project paper quotes 6,428. The SNA variant count also fluctuates as the intermediate report and one document say 73, while the presentation says "~70." These are small differences, but if a reader or the client notices them, it raises questions about which number is correct. Please make sure all three documents agree on the same figures.

Additionally, the client project paper’s Section 2.2 still says "Timothy will standardize" the casing inconsistencies, written in future tense. The intermediate report shows that normalization has actually been completed in code. The paper needs to be updated to reflect what has already been done.

2) Appropriate Selection of Tools, Algorithms, Workflows, and Parameter Values

The tool choices are well-suited to the project. Using Django as the backbone of a reproducible, deployable pipeline is a smart call for a project that’s explicitly designed to be handed off to future student teams. The three different NetworkX graph models — bipartite org-event, org-org co-attendance, and the three-layer directed graph — each serve a distinct analytical purpose, and I liked that you explained what question each one is meant to answer. Having a live deployment at tutormentor.brianhanley.dev also adds real credibility at the intermediate stage.

One thing I’d push back on slightly: the client project paper’s Section 3 doesn’t explain why Django was chosen over simpler alternatives like a standalone Python script or a Jupyter notebook. For a course paper, it would strengthen your argument to briefly justify the framework choice in terms of the project’s reproducibility and deployment goals. It’s obvious why you made that call once you see the live app, but the paper should make it explicit.

Also, the PowerBI dashboard is mentioned in the intermediate report but doesn't appear in the client project paper or the presentation at all. If it's a real deliverable, it should be consistently documented across all three submissions.

3) Quality of Data Analysis, Visualization Results, and Discussion of Insights Gained

The intermediate report's findings section is solid. The key takeaways are specific and meaningful: Program sector dominance at ~50%, the 1999 peak attendance of 565 records, the sharp decline from 2010 onward, and the structural divide between a dense core of long-term participants and a large periphery of single-event attendees. These are exactly the kinds of insights the client and stakeholders can act on.

However, the client project paper's Section 6 is still entirely future-tense and placeholder: "At this stage of the project, analysis and visualization are planned but not yet executed." This is the same issue I noticed in a few other teams' submissions — the paper hasn't been updated to match the actual progress in the intermediate report. All those findings that are clearly documented in the intermediate report need to make their way into the paper.

On the visualization side, the presentation's slide 5 has "[INSERT SCREENSHOT]" as a placeholder for the Plotly chart, and the client project paper's Section 4.2 still says "[Sketch to be updated when received]." These are the kinds of things that should have been cleaned up before submission. The work is clearly done as the live chart is at /chart/ — so it's just a matter of inserting the actual screenshot. I'd also suggest adding a brief conclusion per visualization explaining what each chart tells the client and what they should do with that information.

4) Completeness and Quality of Validation and Redesign

The redesign decisions in the intermediate report are well thought out and well documented. Deliberately deferring the Kumu.io interactive map rather than delivering an incomplete version is a mature call as it's better to be transparent about scope than to ship something half-baked. Removing individual person names from the search to protect privacy is also a good and clearly-reasoned decision, and I appreciated that you documented it explicitly rather than just quietly making the change.

The evaluation section mentions that the intermediate platform was "informally evaluated" against the previous iteration. I think the review is a bit light here — it would help to say who specifically did the evaluation beyond the project sponsor, how many people tested it, and what the methodology was. Right now it reads more like a summary of feedback you received rather than a structured evaluation. Even a brief note about how you gathered that feedback would strengthen this section.

I also noticed that the data quality audit identified 272 blank organization records but noted that these "require a manual lookup against the original source records" and were "targeted for resolution in the final sprint." It would be worth addressing how these blank records are currently being handled in the visualizations; Are they excluded, grouped as ‘Unknown,’ or included as-is? Reviewers and the client will want to know.

5. Overall Quality of Content, Accuracy, and References

The overall quality of the intermediate report is high. The writing is clear and confident, the pipeline is well described, and the Challenges & Opportunities section (Section 8) is one of the most detailed I’ve seen — the ideas around fuzzy organization deduplication with RapidFuzz, D3.js/Sigma.js for interactive network maps, and SNA centrality metrics are all realistic and well-scoped for future teams. Putting those on a public roadmap at /roadmap/ is a great touch for the handoff.

One factual inconsistency I caught: the project sponsor’s name is spelled "Bassill" (two l’s) in the intermediate report and the presentation, but "Bassil" (one l) in the client project paper. This needs to be standardized — whatever the correct spelling is, it should be consistent across all documents. It’s the kind of small error that stands out to a client when they read a paper about themselves.

The AI usage section is honest and specific — calling out the hallucinations that occurred in early descriptions of Team K’s app and noting how you corrected them is exactly the kind of reflection that section is supposed to show. References are appropriate, consistently formatted, and actually relevant to the work. I didn’t notice any significant grammatical issues in the intermediate report, though the client project paper has some rough patches in Section 3 where the placeholder language mixes with real content.

Summary

Overall, Team H has a well-structured project with real, working deliverables at the intermediate stage. The pipeline-first approach, the data quality transparency, and the detailed roadmap for future teams are all standout elements. The main issues are consistency-related: the record count and SNA variant numbers differ across documents, the sponsor’s name is spelled two different ways, and the client project paper has multiple sections that still read as placeholders even though the actual work has clearly been done. Cleaning up those inconsistencies and updating the paper to reflect the current state of the project would make this a very strong final submission.